Speak out

3RD EDITION

B2+
PROGRESS TEST 3 | Version B

Part A • Grammar, Vocabulary and How to …

GRAMMAR

1 Choose the correct options (a, b or c) to complete the sentences.

1 You wouldn't be hungry now if you ___ breakfast before you left for work this morning.
a had **b** 'd had **c** 've had

2 I'd be going to Thailand next week if I ___ lost my passport.
a don't lose **b** haven't lost **c** hadn't lost

3 If we'd hired a car, we ___ sitting on a packed train now.
a hadn't been **b** aren't **c** wouldn't be

4 If you ___ more experienced, they probably would have offered you the job.
a were **b** would be **c** have been

5 If he hadn't reacted so quickly, there ___ a bad accident.
a had been **b** might be **c** might have been

6 The pop star ___ millions of dollars in the last year alone.
a had earned **b** has earned **c** has been earned

7 The company received lots of complaints from customers who ___ badly.
a have treated **b** had treated **c** had been treated

8 More than 35 billion barrels of oil will ___ by the end of the year.
a be consuming **b** have been consumed **c** have consumed

9 The street doesn't appear to ___ for a long time. There's rubbish everywhere.
a have been cleaned **b** have cleaned **c** be cleaned

10 The telephone was returned to its owner after it had ___ in to the police.
a handed **b** been handed **c** been handing

/10

2 Complete the second sentence so that it means the same as the first.

1 They don't only have two dogs, but they also have three cats.
Not _____ two dogs, but they also have three cats.

2 I had never heard such a ridiculous argument before.
Never _____ such a ridiculous argument.

3 You won't be able to change her mind in any way.
In _____ able to change her mind.

4 You should not leave your children alone in the car under any circumstances.
Under _____ your children alone in the car.

5 They can only watch television when they have finished their dinner.
Only _____ their dinner can they watch television.

6 It appears that this classroom has been painted during the holidays.
This classroom appears _____ during the holidays.

7 Someone who wants to sell me new windows keeps contacting me.
I keep _____ by someone who wants to sell me new windows.

8 They might show you around the building if you ask them.
You _____ around the building if you ask them.

9 I was keen to avoid that street after I had been robbed there in the past.
_____ there in the past, I was keen to avoid that street.

10 It was a pleasant surprise when they asked me to host the event.
_____ to host the event was a pleasant surprise.

/10

VOCABULARY

3 Match the sentence beginnings (1–5) with the sentence endings (a–e).

1 I've been having second ___
2 Unfortunately, we didn't assess ___
3 What do you think? I'm torn ___
4 I've always been a creature ___
5 We both get a sense of ___

a between the Thai curry and the mango salad.
b all possible outcomes so a problem occurred.
c comfort from living near our children.
d thoughts about inviting James to the meal.
e of habit so I'm inclined to follow the same routine.

/5

4 Choose the correct words to complete the sentences.

1 Every winter there is a(n) **ecosystem** / **migration** of flamingos to southern Spain.
2 The **breeding** / **reproduce** patterns of these mountain animals have been affected by human activity.
3 The park's security team have arrested a **poacher** / **poaching** suspected of killing hundreds of animals.
4 These large birds usually **prey** / **predator** on small mammals and reptiles.
5 Thanks to the efforts of one **conservation** / **conservationist**, the green space will be protected.

/5

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5 Complete the sentences with words and phrases for algorithms and technology.

1 The quality of the information fed into the program will **d** _ _ _ _ _ _ _ **e** the reliability of the results.
2 The AI algorithm seems to **r** _ _ _ _ _ _ _ **e** unfair ideas about race and gender.
3 I created a spreadsheet in order to **c** _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ **e** insects into their different types.
4 The adventure game takes place in **r** _ _ **l t** _ _ **e** rather than by taking turns.
5 After the two companies merged, they needed to **i** _ _ _ _ _ _ _ **e** their computer systems.

/5

6 Complete the sentences with the words and phrases in the box. There are three words or phrases you do not need.

accidentally	**in the right**	**mistook**	**presumed**
rectify	**slipped up**	**the wrong end of the stick**	
the wrong way			

1 Marina _____ took my phone charger so I need to get it back from her.
2 If you made a mistake with the accounts, the least you can do is _____ it so they're correct.
3 I'm afraid I've _____ and bought the wrong kind of milk.
4 Why do you keep rubbing him up _____?
5 I think you've got _____. That's not what I meant.

/5

HOW TO …

7 Choose the correct options (a, b or c) to complete the sentences.

1 We are launching a(n) ___ to raise awareness of child poverty.
a appeal **b** campaign **c** fundraiser
2 We are concerned about climate ___ where poor nations suffer more from the effects of climate change.
a activities **b** equality **c** inequality
3 The problem with ___ is that the rubbish takes hundreds of years to disappear.
a deforestation **b** landfill **c** hardship
4 A: I wasn't completely convinced by that point.
B: To ___, it didn't make sense.
a put it another way **b** in other words
c what you're saying
5 In a ___, we have developed a plan to solve the problem in the short-term.
a brief **b** recap **c** nutshell
6 The building had been ___ for a while which is why it was pulled down.
a cosy **b** derelict **c** luxurious
7 The green ___ on the wall was caused by a leaking tap.
a mould **b** crack **c** ruin
8 I've put up with your bad attitude for a long time, but this isn't really ___.
a acceptable **b** reasonably **c** unreasonable
9 We ___ you a small discount for the first month.
a can do is **b** could come **c** can offer
10 I think I'd ___ with that.
a be happy **b** accept **c** compromise

/10

Total: /50

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Part B • Listening and Reading

LISTENING

1 [Audio PT3.01] Listen to a podcast in which Hannah and Ian discuss reforestation. Complete the notes with a number, word or short phrase.

1 Reforestation projects aim to make _____ the same as they used to be.
2 A reforestation project to plant one trillion trees was launched in _____.
3 China created a _____ which was thousands of kilometres long.
4 It is thought that a big rise in the number of trees around the world could prevent _____.
5 These days only _____ of Western Europe is covered in forests.
6 Reforestation is an effective way of creating living spaces for _____.
7 One American organisation helps people in developing countries choose _____ for planting.
8 In order to ensure the success of reforestation projects, it is useful to have the help of _____ people.
9 Some countries might prefer to use their land for _____ than for reforestation.
10 A _____ was responsible for a tree planting initiative in northern Spain which suffered a huge fire.

/10

2 [Audio PT3.02] Listen to two waiters talking about things that have gone wrong in their restaurant. Number the topics (A–E) in the order they are mentioned.

A Why it might be difficult to tell someone about a mistake. ___
B A mistake which involved not collecting enough money from customers. ___
C A mistake which involved forgetting to put something away. ___
D Why Cath was unable to rectify her mistake. ___
E How a customer reacted to a mistake. ___

/5

3 [Audio PT3.02] Listen again. Are the statements True (T) or False (F)?

1 Jamie is not surprised that he made a mistake when charging the customers**. T** / **F**
2 Cath encourages Jamie not to worry about the mistake he had made. **T** / **F**
3 The customer who was mistakenly given the leather jacket was apologetic. **T** / **F**
4 Cath has no feelings of guilt about giving the man's jacket to the wrong person. **T** / **F**
5 Chef did not want the meat delivery to be left in the back yard. **T** / **F**

/5

READING

4 Read an article about a life-changing decision. Match the interviewer's questions (A–E) with the paragraphs (1–5).

A Have you got any useful tips for people making similar life-changing decisions?
B What had been happening before you made your life-changing decision?
C How did your decision work out for you?
D How difficult was it to convince your family that it was a good idea?
E What made you decide to set up your own company?

/5

Life-changing decisions

Dev Kumari tells Teresa Ribes about his decision to set up his own company.

1 ___
Before leaving school, I'd been looking forward to going to university. I'd been offered a place at a prestigious university to study chemistry and I was all set to go. However, while all my friends were excitedly packing their bags, I had a change of heart because something didn't feel right. It took me a while to figure out what was causing that feeling, but eventually I realised that I felt stuck in a rut. I'd been a high achiever at school and my career path had been laid out for me by my parents and teachers. From their point of view, I would get a degree and a well-paid career, but I found that my heart just wasn't in it.

2 ___
My parents weren't at all happy about my plans, but they thought I'd think better of my decision and apply for places the following year. Not quite what I had in mind myself. In the meantime, they made it clear that I needed to start making a living because living rent-free at the hotel of mum and dad wasn't an option. That's when I came up with the idea of starting my own business related to my interest in trading cards. For years I'd been buying and selling them online, mostly sports cards, but also things like Pokémon, and I knew that there were opportunities to make money from it. Rather than trading them online, though, I had the idea to open a premises in my town, which would blend a shop with a kind of social hub for collectors.

3 ___
When I first told my parents about my idea they looked at me as if I was crazy. My mum appeared to be the most shaken by the news. She was convinced I was throwing my life away for a childish hobby and that I'd end up jobless with no university education to fall back on. Just what I wanted to hear. Luckily, dad was easier to convince than I'd expected, especially when I reminded him that he had got me into trading cards in the first place! I explained that I'd talked to a business advisor who'd helped me assess all possible outcomes, and a bank had even agreed to give me a loan. He seemed quite impressed when he realised that I'd done all that work on my own.

4 ___
When I'd been developing the business plan, it all seemed quite straightforward. I'd need to get a premises, build up a big enough stock of trading cards and other merchandise, market the business and wait for the money to roll in. However, in reality, it was way harder than that because there were so many issues which I hadn't expected. As a result, there were times when I had second thoughts, but I didn't have a back-up plan so I had to keep going. That said, although business was initially slow, it began to pick up when word about it got around. My idea that collectors would want a space to hang out as well as buy and sell cards paid off.

5 ___
I'd emphasise the importance of not making any decisions on impulse. It's no use setting up a company before thinking better of it because it brings too many responsibilities. You've only got one shot to get it right. I'd also suggest approaching your family with care because they might not be as encouraging as you expect. They just want what's best for you and, if you seem indecisive, you probably won't be able to persuade them that your plan is effective. That said, you shouldn't be afraid of getting out of your comfort zone either. Overcoming difficulties is what makes life worth living. If I hadn't done that, I'd probably be sitting in a chemistry lecture right now, wondering 'What if?'

5 Read the article again. Choose the correct answer (A, B, C or D).

1 Dev decided not to go to university because
A he wanted to pursue a well-paid career instead.
B he felt trapped in a pattern of life and study.
C he was worried he would miss his friends.
D he had never wanted to go to university.

2 Dev decided to start a trading card company because
A he was expected to do something to earn money.
B he needed money in order to move away from home.
C it was something he had already experience in.
D it was an opportunity to do business online.

3 Dev thought it would be more difficult to
A share the news of his business with his mother.
B make a judgement about his business plan.
C persuade the bank to lend him money.
D convince his father of his business plan.

4 Dev nearly changed his mind about the business after
A experiencing difficulties which he had not anticipated.
B discovering that his business plan was not effective.
C failing to come up with a back-up plan.
D realising that collectors wanted a different experience.

5 Dev recommends
A making business decisions without thinking too much about them.
B avoiding taking on too much responsibility when setting up a company.
C sometimes doing things which are unfamiliar to you and make you nervous.
D finishing your university studies before setting up your own company.

/10

6 Read an article in which three members of the same family talk about a social media app called Flutter. Tick the topics (1–6) which are mentioned.

1 Jonah describes feeling uncomfortable about taking part in conversations on social media. ___
2 Jonah felt that some of the content which appeared in his feed was inappropriate for him. ___
3 Gemma explains why she found it hard to get used to using the Flutter app. ___
4 Gemma would prefer not to engage with content which causes an emotional response. ___
5 Patrick thinks that people his age are prone to struggle with social media. ___
6 Patrick was only able to find content which interested him with some assistance. ___

/6

Flutter
Three generations of the same family share their views on the new social media app which has been hitting the headlines.

Jonah, 19, student
I remember reading about Flutter when it was in development, but I haven't heard much about it since then and I don't know anyone who uses it. Personally speaking, I'm more inclined to use video-based apps, where 'likes' and emojis are the main way of responding to other users. While there are plenty of videos on Flutter, you need to take part in the conversations if you want to get the most out of it. That means being careful about how you express yourself, especially if you don't want people to get the wrong end of the stick. I found out the hard way after posting a joke which seemed to upset some users. It was only by apologising that I was able to put it right. In general, it fed me content related to sports and I loved the clips of people doing football tricks. They were quite motivating and made me want to practise the tricks myself. If I was more competent at making videos, I might even have uploaded some of my own! I made sure I 'liked' the things that interested me most because that's how the algorithms determine what you'll be shown. Nevertheless, some of the stuff in my feed was a bit off, like the video games content which it kept generating. I presume that's because I'm a young man and it makes the assumption that all young men are into that. However, if the algorithm knew me better, it would know that doesn't interest me at all!

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Gemma, 48, lecturer
I've been using a similar app for some time, which is popular in my field of work. It's widely used by academics for sharing and discussing research findings both with colleagues and the general public. Not only does Flutter look almost identical to that app, but content is also categorised in the same way. I guess if I hadn't used apps like this before, it might have been harder to get used to, but I didn't have any issues. The first thing I did was to join conversations related to my academic field, and I came across some lines of research that I wasn't familiar with. However, some of the comments rubbed me up the wrong way because users weren't treating each other with the respect you'd expect in academic conversations. Even with other topics, like cookery, there seemed to be a great deal of rudeness amongst the contributors. In fact, had I known people were using Flutter to spread negative opinions, I might have avoided it altogether. I don't know how the algorithm in this app works, but there's no doubt that it was reinforcing negative views. It was clear to me that I was being fed content which would cause a more emotional response and, because of that, in no way would I use it again. In future, I'll stick to reading blogs and my usual social media apps.

Patrick, 76, retired
I sometimes use social media apps for keeping up with friends and family and, despite my age, I don't have too many problems! The way the content is organised makes it easy to find the things I want to read about. Flutter seemed more complicated, though, and I couldn't figure out how to follow the topics I'm curious about. I'd been told that you need to use hashtags, but I haven't got a clue what they are. That's probably why so much of the content seemed so irrelevant to me. For instance, these ridiculous comedy videos kept appearing, which really got on my nerves. The same videos and messages came up again and again, but I couldn't figure out how to rectify it. In the end, Gemma managed to find some conversations about gardening for me, which were far more appropriate. I got into a few arguments about how to look after your lawn, but, as I'm a bit of an expert on that, I enjoyed being able to put people right! I found it strange how the algorithm miscalculated my interests though, like the comedy videos. Only when I started taking part in gardening conversations did it seem to understand what I was interested in.

7 Read the article again. Are the statements True (T) or False (F)?

1 Jonah is concerned about the possibility of causing misunderstandings on Flutter. **T** / **F**
2 Jonah was prepared to upload his own videos despite not being sufficiently competent. **T** / **F**
3 Jonah and Gemma both express a positive attitude towards Flutter's algorithm. **T** / **F**
4 Gemma may have had more difficulty using Flutter without previous experience of similar apps. **T** / **F**
5 Gemma was disappointed with the type of content she was being provided with. **T** / **F**
6 Gemma and Patrick share the same view about Flutter's ease of use. **T** / **F**
7 Patrick became frustrated with the content he was first shown on Flutter. **T** / **F**
8 Patrick enjoyed correcting other users on Flutter when he disagreed with their views. **T** / **F**
9 Patrick and Jonah were both reluctant to take part in conversations on Flutter. **T** / **F**

/9

Total: /50

Part C • Speaking and Writing

SPEAKING

1 Listen to your partner talk about their pictures. Ask: Which of the situations might the people find more stressful?

2 Describe and compare the pictures showing people experiencing life changes. How do you think the people are feeling?





/15

3 Answer your partner's question.

/5

WRITING

4 Complete the sentences with the words and phrases in the box. There are three words or phrases you do not need.

congratulations	**considerable disappointment**	
fit for purpose	**get a chance**	**have no doubt**
I'm sure	**let me know**	**make matters worse**

1 I know you've got a lot of work on at the moment, but why don't you call me when you _____?
2 I can't wait to see you at the weekend. _____ we'll have a great time.
3 The food in the restaurant was terrible. To _____, we were given our dishes in the wrong order.
4 I'm writing to express my _____ at the delay to our flight last Friday.
5 The ensuite bathroom in our hotel room was not _____. It was dirty and the shower did not work.

/5

5 You have recently enrolled on a course and you are disappointed with the service. Write an email of complaint stating:

- **why you are writing.**
- **what the problems were (e.g. the materials, the teaching, the support, the qualifications offered, etc.).**
- **what the desired outcomes are.**

Write 200–260 words.

/15

Total: /40